

Introduction

Mobile operating systems were previously something that no one paid much heed to. They existed, they did what you wanted and you didn't care too much as long as your desires were fulfilled. These last few years have changed all of that. Our needs, our style of working – they've all changed and almost exclusively revolve around our mobile devices. The mobile OS is now our primary gateway to the world we want to experience and it has to evolve to support our needs.

With the introduction of the iPhone, Apple was successful in effecting a shift in the way phones were used. This was largely due to the way the operating system interacted with the underlying hardware – capacitive screen et al. Jump a few years ahead and you have iOS6 – an incremental release sure but somehow “behind-the-curve”. iOS7 on the other hand is a major step in the right direction. It may not be finished, it may even be a jarring change for some but without a doubt, this is the future of iOS and one that's been a long time coming. This new direction is in its own way, quite exciting. It's a direction that even Apple seems to be grappling with and while they've done a remarkably good job in redefining an OS that has been their signature for almost seven years, there are some flaws and some hurdles that they're yet to overcome.

Whether you love it or hate it, iOS7 is here to stay. It's an OS that has finally embraced the modern era and has adapted to provide the functionality that one has come to expect from any OS. Just as Apple has adapted, so must we. This FT to iOS7 aims to do just that, a distilled introduction to the world of iOS7, everything that you would need to know to work with, and develop for, this new platform. 